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The Secret To Successful Shlichus Expansion

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LONG

THE PHRASE “SHLIACH OSEH SHLIACH” (SOS) HAS BEEN ASSOCIATED WITH **CONFLICT AND FEAR, NEGATIVITY AND PESSIMISM**. FOR SOME IT CONJECTURES DISCONTENT WITH THE HIERARCHY OF SHLICHUS—IT’S THE “**SAME OLD STORY,**” JUST ANOTHER BREAKDOWN IN RELATIONSHIPS. FOR OTHERS ENTRENCHED IN CONTROVERSY, IT IS **NOTHING SHORT OF A CRY FOR HELP**.

The truth is that conflict surrounding shliach oseh shliach has always been around, even prompting many responses from the Rebbe.¹ Yet the Rebbe insisted that shliach oseh shliach—“afilu me’ah”²—was practical and not merely wishful thinking. It was the Rebbe seeing the way shlichus can and should be.

To be sure, it does seem that conflict has become more commonplace over the last 5-10 years, making it challenging to remain optimistic in such a system. However, considering the 315% growth rate in shlichus over the last 20 years³ (three times more shluchim went out in this period than during the 50 years that preceded it), it is completely normal to see a spike in conflicts.

When an organization expands there are always growing pains. And pain leads to fear. It is the reaction to that fear that sets the subsequent course. Promulgating the breakdowns of inter-shluchim relationships is undoubtedly the work of the Klugener and if left unchecked can take a serious toll on the expansion of shlichus. The fact is that after two decades of extraordinary

continuous growth, the rate of expansion of shlichus is in decline. Causes for decline can range from financial limitations to geographic saturation, or can be correlated to the negativity surrounding shliach oseh shliach.

In either case, shliach oseh shliach remains the most opportunistic source of the future expansion of shlichus. Since the expansion of shlichus and the ambition of shliach oseh shliach is way too important to let klipas Midyan⁴ infiltrate the ranks of the Rebbe’s army, particularly after the Rebbe prescribed the antidote of *Heichaltzu*, it is imperative that we confront this dynamic challenge swiftly and resolutely.

Rabbi Hesh Epstein, shliach to Columbia, South Carolina who has been working the front lines of mediation for many years, cautions, “Happy shluchim don’t often air their stories. As a result, the disproportionate amount of bad news compared to good news can lead to suspicion, which may account for the stagnation.” Don’t let unbridled fear and pessimism take over the great aspiration of shliach oseh shliach. The fact is that there are many very successful shliach oseh shliach relationships.

It is time to push back the assumption that shliach oseh shliach doesn’t work and put the fear to rest. It is time to restore confidence in the system that absolutely does work and return the mandate of shliach oseh shliach to its proper context as an absolute SOS—sign of strength.

IT TAKES A SHLIACH TO MAKE A SHLIACH

The Rebbe spoke many times about the fourth level of shlichus (see sidebar on page 29), where the shliach transcends the “kemoso” of the meshaleach and actually becomes the *metzius* of the meshaleach.⁵ At this level he possesses the koach to appoint a new shliach to carry out the mission of hafatzas hayahdus and hafatzas hamaayanos chutzah.

“If you are a shliach who wants to

1 *Shlichus Kehilchisa* p. 318+

2 *Toras Menachem* 5745 vol. 1 p. 460

3 Statistics from Chabadone.org Shluchim Directory

4 *Igros Kodesh* vol. 21 p. 296

5 *Toras Menachem* 5744 vol. 1 p. 520, *Toras Menachem* 5744 vol. 4 p. 2449

bring down another shliach but are plagued by fear, you need to remember that this was the Rebbe's vision," says Rabbi Yossi Mintz, shliach to Redondo Beach, California. "And as a shliach empowered to make more shluchim you cannot be subjected by fears."

"To make room for another shliach," says Rabbi Chaim Block, shliach to S. Antonio, Texas, "you have to recognize that it is not about you, it's about the bigger picture. Yes, of course there are risks and yes, fundamental adjustments to your shlichus must be made. However, without risks there is no growth."

At the fourth level of shlichus—"mah shekanah eved kanah rabo"⁶—shliach oseh shliach is entirely the strength of the meshaleach who has empowered you to perpetuate the mission with your entire essence. It is the ultimate level a shliach can aspire to. The gripping fear of making a new shliach may be strong, but the koach hameshaleach is b'ein aroch stronger.

"If you want to grow a city and not be satisfied with mediocrity or a diminished shlichus," continues Rabbi Block, "then recognize that you can't do it alone. Acknowledging that bringing in a new shliach is best for the mosad's growth counters the challenges of shliach oseh shliach."

"Fundamental to the mission is to never be satisfied," explains Rabbi Epstein. "It is therefore that shliach oseh shliach is crucial to the long term growth and success of the mission. A new shliach brings a new energy and vision and pushes you to take risks and explore opportunities you couldn't and wouldn't otherwise have done. It is the antithesis of stagnation. It tells the community that you are vibrant and growing."

Rabbi Mintz takes it a step further. "Since 'ain partzoseihen shavos' and 'ain dei'oseihen shavos,' every individual has his unique personality and can connect with other individuals in

his own way. People with whom you couldn't connect sometimes connect with the new shluchim and become closer to Yiddishkeit as a result."

Therefore, making more shluchim to help you serve your community is a necessary medium to effectively reaching every Jew in your community. Shliach oseh shliach is a critical component of your shlichus and should be employed wherever and whenever possible, afilu me'ah.

IT TAKES A VISIONARY TO MAKE PARTNERS

In the early twentieth century, a young lawyer setting out to establish himself observed the prevailing system amongst the law firms at that time: associates were trained as apprentices to a sole practitioner and were compensated for revenue they generated for him. He recognized the inefficiency and shortcomings inherent in that prevailing structure and decided to change it, implementing what is now known as the Cravath System at his law firm:

1. Hire the best lawyers who are passionate and dedicated to the practice of law as a profession, who demonstrate a willingness to work hard and pay meticulous attention to the quality of the work.
2. Once at the firm, associates are required to go through rigorous and extensive training in order to develop critical skills and a breadth of knowledge that will better service the firm's clients.
3. Associates are paired with a senior partner who serves as their mentor.
4. Over time, the most talented of the associates become partners.

Achieving greatness and success wasn't inherent just because a person graduated law school. To get the most out of an individual they introduced a system of learning, training, mentoring, and growth within the organization to maximize the young lawyer's potential. They sought the best individuals with the most passion and dedication to the mission. They gave him a ladder to climb and the tools he needed

to make the climb. They showed him what he could become if he was to reach the top of the ladder and that was incentive enough for him to rise above and beyond. This partnership model became the envy of every law firm in the country and is in use in virtually every American law firm today.

For decades on end, the best and the brightest were snatched up from kollel. Yungerleit with the most passion and dedication were taught to navigate the world of shlichus with training and mentorship. They were given a ladder upon which climbing from strength to strength day in and day out was not optional, but mandated in the mission of being a shliach. They worked belev vanefesh, becoming active partners in the task to make their makom hashlichus ready for Moshiach.

But lately, with the manifestation of klipas Midyan, more and more shluchim admit they would rather bring down a new shliach who is quiet and not a "front line man" for fear of being outshined. "His success is your success," reminds Rabbi Mintz. "And just as a business seeks the best individual for the job, so does shlichus deserve the best individuals with the best potential to fulfill the mandate."

"Kav shelo," as the Rebbe spoke, is not a threat to the organization, but the impetus for something extraordinary about to be accomplished. "It means giving your shliach a realm he can call his own," says Rabbi Block. "A program he can grow, a place in the community for him to strive toward, something he can identify with. And then, working side-by-side, you'll see his success and share that happiness."

"Before you sit down to hire," says Rabbi Epstein, "look at your mosad strategically and make a five-year plan of where you'd like your mosad to go. What role will the new shliach play to get you to that destination? Find his place in the organization."

For most new shluchim this position is their first job. You have

⁶ *Toras Menachem* 5744 vol. 1 p. 520



לאחרי כל עבודתם של השלוחים בכל מקום ומקום, עבודה שאכן נעשתה מתוך מסירת נפש וכו' — הרי כאשר מדובר אודות ענייני טוב וקדושה הקשורים עם הקב"ה שהוא "אין סוף", מובן, שאין גבול ושיעור לדבר, כך שתמיד ניתן להוסיף יותר ויותר — לשלוח שלוחים נוספים.

ובהתאם לכך — באה ההצעה דלקמן:

כל שליו — שלוחו של כ"ק מו"ח אדמו"ר נשיא דורנו, שלוחו של אדם כמותו, כמותו דהמשלח ממש, שהוא שלוחו של אדם העליון שעל הכסא — ישתדל לשלוח שלוחים מדילי, שגם הם יעסקו בהפצת המעיינות במקומות שבסביבתו, שכן, שליו עושה שליו, אפילו מאה שלוחים, וכן הלאה, עד סוף כל הדורות.

ומכיון ש"תפסת מרובה לא תפסת", מובן, שאין להתחיל מיד לשלוח מאה שלוחים, אלא יש להתחיל עם שליו אחד, כלומר, שכל שליו ישתדל למצוא אדם מוכשר ומתאים שימנהו כשלוחו (שלוחו של אדם כמותו), לעסוק בהפצת המעיינות במקום נוסף הנמצא בסביבתו, ולאחרי שיראה שהדבר הולך ומצליח — אזי יחשוב ע"ד שליו נוסף.

ופשיטא, שכל זה אינו על חשבון המוסדות הקיימים כבר, להרוס ח"ו ענין אחד כדי לבנות ענין זה, כי אם באופן של בנין ע"ג בנין.

משיחת ש"פ בראשית תשמ"ה (תורת מנחם תשמ"ה ח"א ע' 460)

NOTWITHSTANDING ALL THE WORK THAT THE SHLUCHIM DO WITH MESIRAS nefesh, in areas of goodness and holiness there is always room to increase. Accordingly, I suggest that every shliach — who is exactly like the meshale'ach — should send his own shluchim to assist in hafatzas hama'yanos in his area.

One shliach can make another shliach, extending even to one hundred shluchim and beyond. However, a shliach should begin gradually. He should first appoint one appropriate candidate as his shliach in a nearby area and then, once this is successful, he should think about adding another shliach. Obviously this can't be done at the expense of existing mosdos but rather should build upon them.

Sichah of Shabbos Bereishis 5745 (Toras Menachem 5745, vol. 1, p. 460)

to guide them and mentor them. Not compete and be threatened by their success. "Unlike corporate America," says Rabbi Block, "shluchim are there for life. It may start as an employee-employer relationship but should morph into partnerships."

Once, a shliach informed the Rebbe that he would like to bring a new shliach to his Chabad House. After selecting the right candidate, he notified the Rebbe and the Rebbe gave his blessing for success. Shortly thereafter, the shliach went into the Rebbe for yechidus. The first question the Rebbe asked was, "Where is your partner?"

"Kav shelo" is the attainment of the fourth level of shlichus⁸ and the secret to the miraculous success shluchim have accomplished in recent times. It is the real secret of shlichus and the envy of every major Jewish organization around the world.

THE FUTURE LANDSCAPE OF SHLICHUS

"The science is out there," says Rabbi Mintz. "Two people working together can lift something heavier than the combined sum of what each can carry on his own." By making new shluchim, you will achieve so much more than you can imagine. This is what ultimately separates the great from the good."

Big buildings and large events are yesterday's barometer of success. Today the barometer should be the success of shliach oseh shliach relationships. As Rabbi Epstein puts it succinctly, "people, not programs, are your biggest assets."

"Resolve fears," says Rabbi Mintz, "by following the Rebbe's hora'ah with due diligence in fundraising and setting up contractual policies that protect each shliach." As the Rebbe says, "the more details the contract covers the fewer problems you will have later on."

Refocus on the truth and the fact that shliach oseh shliach works. The

⁷ Shlichus Kehilchisa p. 261

⁸ Toras Menachem 5744 vol. 4 p. 2449

⁹ Shlichus Kehilchisa p. 267

Rebbe understood its challenges and gave clear directives on when and how to expand. If you follow the advice and do the due diligence before hiring, then the outcomes have a greater chance of being successful.

The future landscape of shlichus is entirely dependent on our ability to create successful shliach oseh shliach relationships and our attitudes towards conflict and resolution. It's not about hiring a shliach but rather the "making" of a shliach. With the right guidance, training, support, and autonomy, he can be successful and become a real partner in your shlichus.

As the number of shluchim in the Rebbe's army draws nearer to 5,000 strong, remember that shlichus didn't get this far through fear and pessimism. It did so through the utmost conviction that there is a mission to fulfill and a meshaleach who has empowered each and every shliach with the koach to fulfill that mission.

In your arsenal is the ultimate power to make a shliach, and another, and another—aflū me'ah. Wielding that power successfully is a story worth sharing. 

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מציאות דהמשלח עצמו

נוסף לזה, ישנם כאלו שזכו לשליחות מיוחדת – שליחותו של כ"ק מו"ח אדמו"ר נשיא דורנו (או ע"י שלוחו, שהרי שליח עושה שליח כו') לעסוק בהפצת היהדות בכלל, ובמיוחד – בהפצת המעיינות (עד ל)חוצה.

ולכן, יש להם כל העילויים ד"שליח: שלוחו של אדם כמותו, עד כמותו ממש – דנשיא דורנו, "הנשיא הוא הכל".

וכפי שכבר נכתב ונתבאר בנוגע לשלוחים שבארץ הקודש ונפשיטא שענין זה שייך גם לשלוחים הנמצאים כאן, וכן לשלוחים שבכל העולם כולו] – שישנם כמה דרגות ואופנים בענין השליחות:

א. מעשה השליח הוא דהמשלח, ב. אבר השליח (שעל ידו מקיים את השליחות) הוא דהמשלח, ג. כל מציאות השליח היא כמותו דהמשלח.

וישנה דרגא רביעית בזה נומכיון שהמשלח הוא נשיא דורנו ששמו "יוסף", שהנה גתו היתה באופן ד"טוב עין הוא יבורך" – בוודאי נתן גם את הדרגא הרביעית (הכי נעלית) שבשליחותו: לא זו בלבד שמציאותו של השליח היא כמותו דהמשלח (עד כמותו ממש), אלא הוא מציאות המשלח עצמו, ע"ד המדובר כמ"פ אודות פירוש הרשב"א בענין "מה שקנה עבד קנה רבו" – שאין הכוונה שמתחילה קונה העבד ואח"כ קונה רבו ממנו, אלא מלכתחילה קונה רבו, מכיון שהעבד אינו מציאות לעצמו, כי כל מציאותו אינה אלא מציאות רבו, ולכן, כאשר העבד מקבל לידו דבר מסוים – מיד קונה רבו.

אמנם, דרושה זהירות שהשליח לא ישנה משליחותו (בהתאם לרצון המשלח), כי כאשר משנה שליחותו – בטלה מציאותו בתור שליח ("ער ווערט אויס שליח"), ופשיטא – ביטול מציאותו בתור מציאות המשלח.

אבל לאידך – כאשר ממלא את שליחותו כפי רצון המשלח, יש לו את כל התוקף ד"שליח", שלוחו של אדם כמותו ממש, עד לדרגא הד' שבשליחות כנ"ל. ובמילא, בכוחו למנות עוד שליח (שליח עושה שליח וכו') כדי למלא את התפקיד והשליחות דהפצת היהדות והמעיינות חוצה.

[משיחת ע"פ חולדות חשד"מ (תורת מנחם חשד"מ ח"א ע' 520-521)]

THOSE WHO MERITED TO BE SHLUCHIM OF MY FATHER-IN-LAW THE [FRIEDIKER] Rebbe (or through his shliach) to spread Yiddishkeit, and specifically the wellsprings of Chassidus, possess all the advantages of a "shliach" in that they are exactly like the meshale'ach, the Rebbe.

There are various possible levels in the relationship between a meshale'ach and his shliach: (1) The shliach's action is attributed to the meshale'ach; (2) The limb of the shliach who performs the shlichus is considered to be part of the meshale'ach; (3) The shliach's entire being is like the meshale'ach. The [Friediker] Rebbe's shlichus is on a fourth and far loftier level, at which the shliach is one and the same as the meshale'ach. This is comparable to the way a slave's acquisition belongs to his master (as elucidated by the Rashba): it is not that the slave acquires an object and then it becomes the master's property, but, rather, because the slave does not have any independent existence, the acquisition immediately effectuates the master's ownership.

A person must take heed, however, not to deviate from the shlichus (as desired by the meshale'ach), for this would void his status as a shliach. But as long as he fulfills his shlichus properly, he has all the virtues of being a shliach like the meshale'ach and thus can in turn appoint another shliach to assist in hafatzas hayahadus and hamaayanos.

Sichah of Shabbos Toldos 5744 (Toras Menachem 5744, vol. 1, pp. 520-521)